

RAW

Simply put, they are the best option if you are looking to get the highest quality file from your camera. Most professional photographers prefer this file format because if you do not use raw files then the camera will make adjustments to the original data (the digital image) after which it is stored in a format such as JPEG. This reduces the scope of editing.

Everything from exposure, saturation, sharpness, white balance, etc. can be worked on later in a photo editing software. Beware of the fact that photographing in this format will require you to have extra memory cards handy since they are massive in size.

Pros:

- Highest quality image can be captured
- Loads of options when it comes to the post processing stage

Cons:

- Higher turnaround time to convert and edit these kind of files
- Bigger files will mean higher storage being needed and longer time for post processing

DNG

Almost every new camera these days come with their own proprietary format that captures RAW data. Even when it comes to multiple cameras from the same company, they will use different formats which means that editing software have to constantly evolve to keep up with changing demands.

This when DNG as a file format was born. This format, created by Adobe, was their answer to standardising RAW file formats across all companies and their cameras. DNG is offered as the main RAW file format or as an alternative to the manufacturing company's RAW format. But by using the DNG convertor, you can store files in the DNG format and this provides for future security as well.

Pros:

- Allows you to use processing software such as Photoshop and Lightroom
- Safer option long term

Cons:

- Longer time needed to convert camera RAW files to DNG format

PNG

This file format was designed in the '90s and was seen as being an improvement to the GIF file format. The ideal use of PNG is for the internet. The